

I fear



Recent works by.
Yunus Khimani

Cover Image,
OMG ,Hand painted with natural dyes on canvas 78" X 49" (197 X 124 cms) 2024.

“In fond memories of Haroon and Molina”

Yunus Khimani - an indisposition

Yunus Khimani's preoccupation with "fear", is neither its physicality, nor its psychotic implications or manifestations. Having personally known the artist, educator, conceptualizer and motivator for over 50 years, I feel that these various manifestations are truly his source of energy and inspiration, with a sense of synergizing several aspects of creative inter-disciplines. He strongly feels that most of his fears relate to the present and its future; but certainly, they have their roots in the past.

In the words of T.S.Eliot, that he seems to be tremendously inspired by,

Time present and time past.
Are both perhaps present in time future. *

Tradition was contemporary once. Its validity needs to be understood and its implications interpreted with foresight. Speaking of the past, the untimely passing of Molina, the deep love of his life, left behind an immense emptiness that ultimately became the canvas of his artistic reawakening. The multiplicity of his creative being, driven by academic, design oriented and educational intermingling, motivated his endeavors to envisage a futuristic vision. Perhaps, that is what frightens him today. "We work for a better tomorrow". In his words, it doesn't seem so, and it truly frightens him. This "fear" of his, forms the real and true basis of his creative energy, which he achieves by synergizing and revalidating tradition along with some of those forms that could lose their vitality and relevance with time. His fears revolve around the chaos in the world around us, the impact and penetration of e-commerce, our overwhelming reliance on technology, the irrelevant reverence of materialism, the normalized suppression of the weak, along with false truths and honest lies feeding narrative bubbles of democratic media, fuelling a geopolitical disquietude on the brink of hatred, war and blinded loyalties.

Yunus's creative revelations, to me, are symbols of anxiety symbolically expressed both in content and form, drawing our attention to the blind and deaf discourses in our everyday existence. The vulnerability of human existence as a result of this transformation, reminds us of the works of artist Edward Munch and his 'Scream', which shimmers in a state of universal dysphoria. This omnipresent dysphoria screams to us loudly even today, with suppressions, oppressions and divisions magnified through lenses of caste, creed, colour, regionality, nationality and serpentine tussles for global economic domination.

Although, Picasso, in his *Guernica*, depicts a series of universal symbols of suffering caused by violence, in his condemnation of the times; the painting's ambiguity sans any political allusion, as also in the case of Yunus's works, allows it to represent all forms of violence, remaining eternally relevant. Yunus's themes deliberately avoid specific references, while remaining within the larger contexts of his "fear" that are explicitly embodied in his works. Yunus's multiple 'faces' are manifestations of the diverse creative forms he has experienced, embraced and evolved with, throughout his artistic journey. From materials like paper, bamboo and plastic; to techniques like casting, forming and soldering; to forms that move from hand-painted dye to sculptures and installations; Yunus's net widens restlessly, resisting all desire for a signature that settles but allowing impressions and inspirations to move and nourish freely.

Much like Rauschenberg's "Combines", Yunus's inherent free spiritedness and formal expansiveness endears him to the collaborative integration between traditions, revitalizing them through contemporary creative expression. As part of this journey, his collaborations have broken colonially imprinted hierarchies that visibly and invisibly separate craft from content.

Aiming to inclusively evolve a practice that explores materials, techniques and processes to discover new aesthetic possibilities, Yunus Khimani, with his 50 years of artistic and academic experience, collaborates with Giriraj Chippa (block printer of Dabu and Bagru prints) and Badshah Miyan (master craftsman in Lehariya and Bandhej) to synergies creative energies. Looking at a different way of working within traditional techniques, the group tries to push and transform aesthetic sensibilities and its limits. They attempt doing so in a way that is sustainable in the long run, using biodegradable material that is respectful of environmental concerns, and do so inclusively, without the tenets of ownership and hierarchy.

Works of art are essentially meant to be seen and experienced. Words can only facilitate this experience. The exhibition comprises of a large body of work experimented and executed over a period of time. Besides being integrative of the interdisciplinary that interests Yunus and his team of creative collaborators, this body of work showcases hand-painted dye on canvas with natural material, along with digital prints on canvas and mixed media experimentations. It would be pertinent to mention that this experimentation is the result of an amalgamation of diverse sensibilities, driven by a common goal of celebrating tradition and yet inventing new contemporary thresholds.

“I fear”, therefore, directionally transforms the artist’s urgencies and energies into a collaborative reflective mosaic that evolves into its own interactive indisposition.

Prof. Dr. Rajeev Lochan

Former director - National Gallery of Modern Art

In association with Yuriko Lochan and Kunal Chandra

*Couplet taken from Four Quartets by T. S. Eliot

I fear.....

I fear the chaotic world around me

I fear the penetration of ecommerce

I fear the advent of technology

I fear Ai and now SI

I fear for the weak

I fear the false dignity bestowed by wealth

I fear the rich and famous

I fear the rise of suppression and oppression

I fear the rise in corruption

I fear the menace of violence

I fear the lies perpetrated by and through the social media

I fear the rise of right wing

I fear the death of democracy

I fear the lawlessness taking over

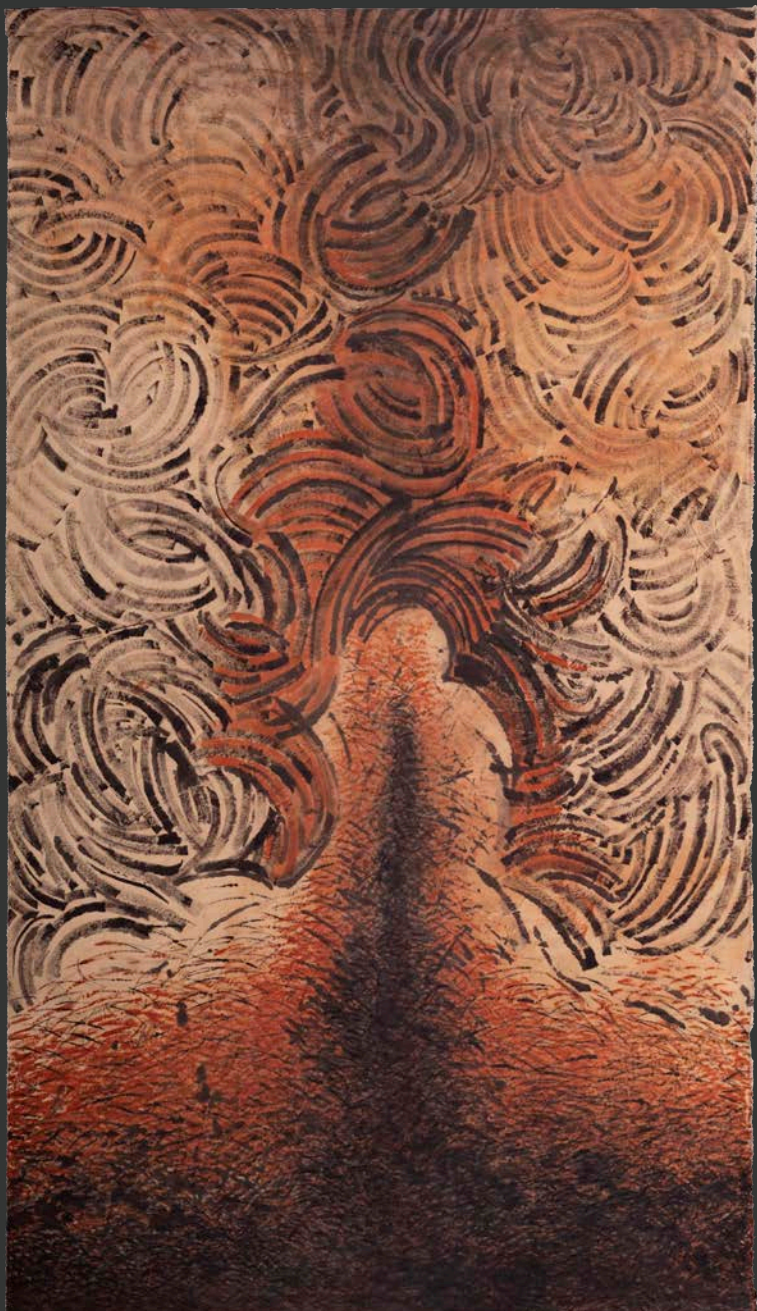
I fear the religious terrorism

I fear the specter of hatred

I fear the many raging wars

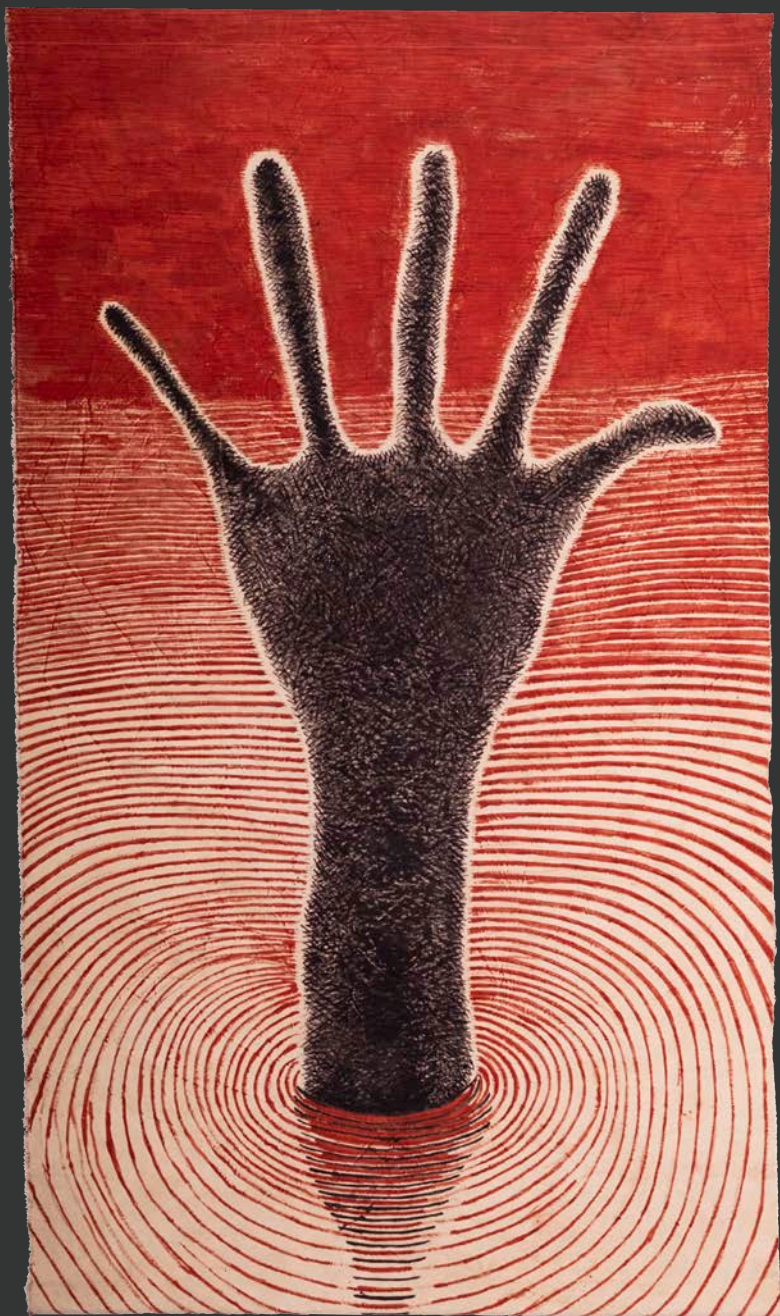
I fear the constitution of fear as policy

I fear.....



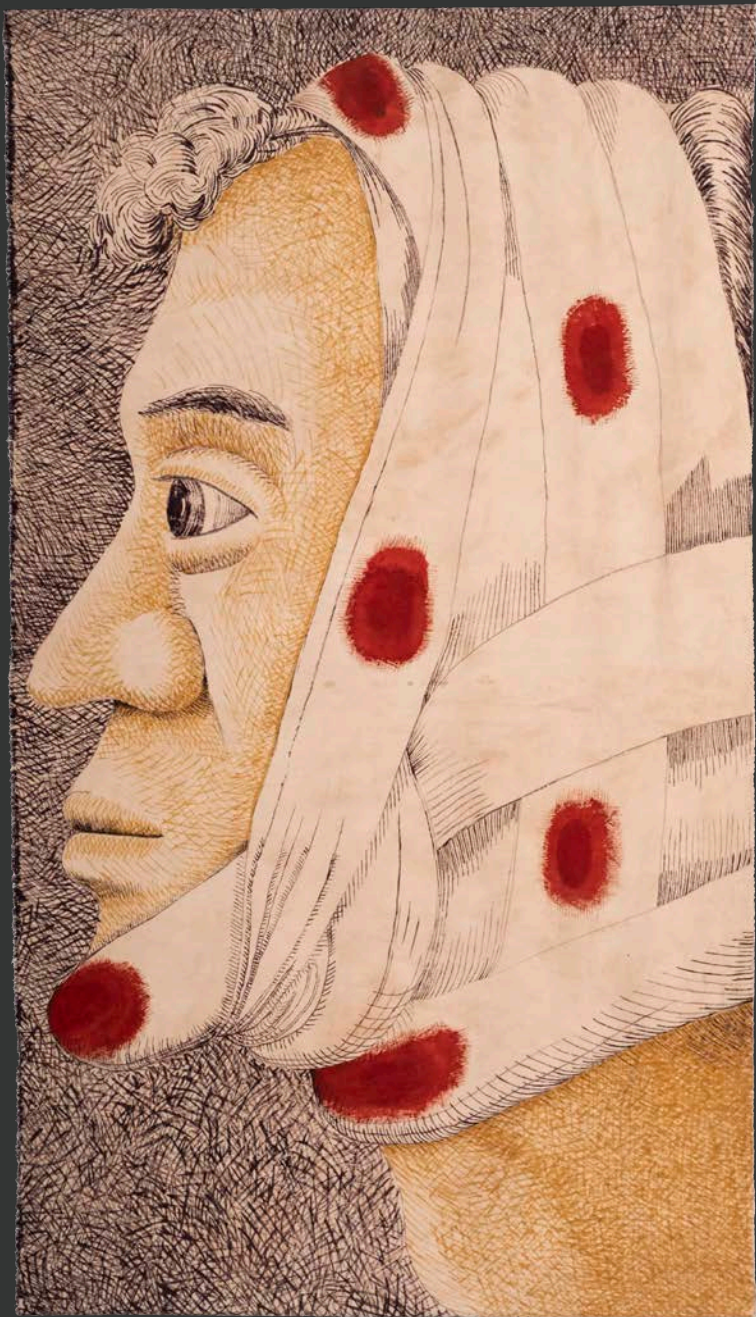
Wasteland

Hand painted with natural dyes on canvas
87" X 49" (222 X 124 cms) ,
2024



Drowning

Hand painted with natural dyes on canvas
85" X 49" (215 X 124 cms) ,
2025



Injured

Hand painted with natural dyes on canvas
86" X 49" (218 X 124 cms) ,
2025



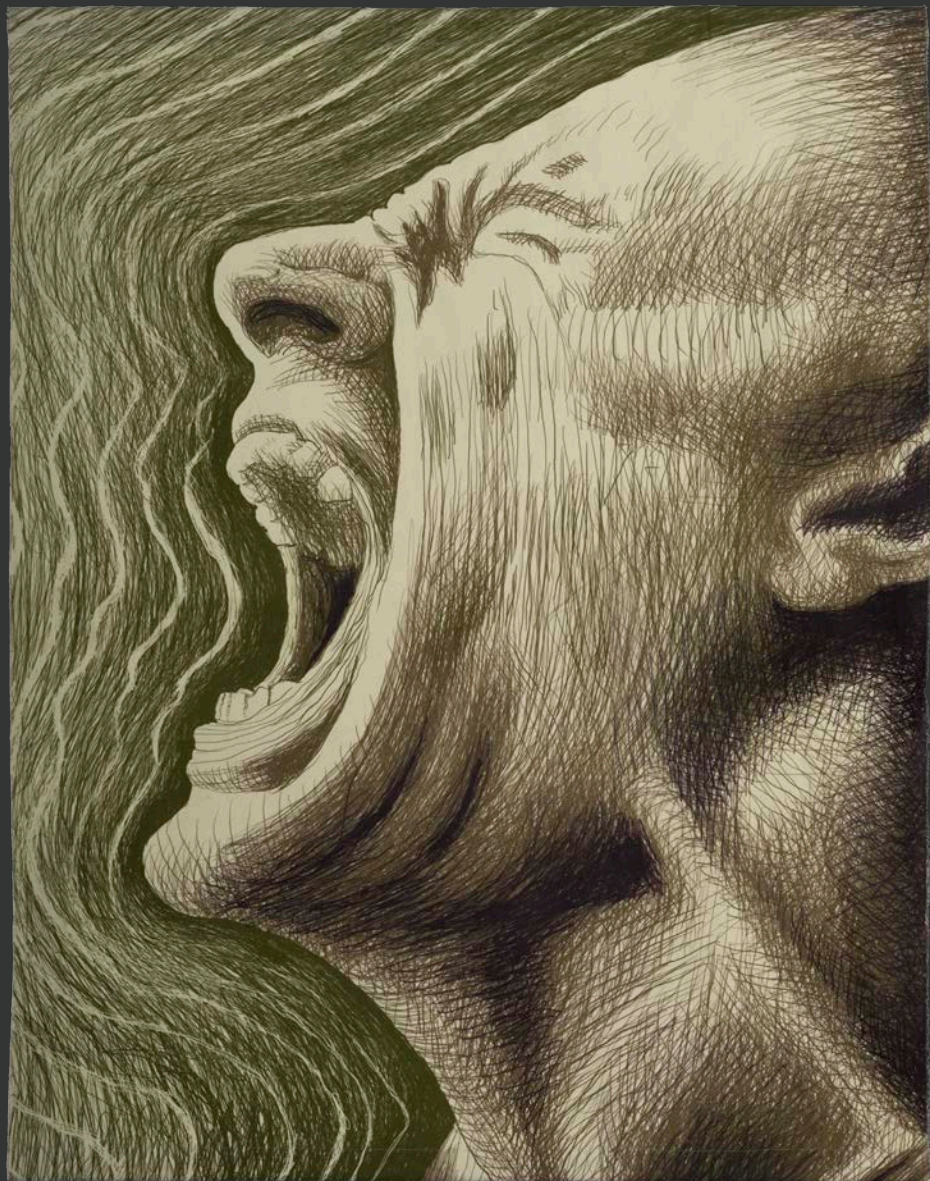
Cloud monster

Hand painted with natural dyes on canvas
85" X 49" (215 X 124 cms) ,
2025



I cry

Done on my iPad Pro and digital print on canvas
79" X 61" (201 X 156)
63" X 49" (160 X 124)
2024



Scream

Done on my iPad Pro and digital print on canvas

77" X 61" (201 X 156)

62" X 49" (160 X 124)

2024



I cry

Done on my iPad Pro and digital print on canvas

77" X 61" (201 X 156)

62" X 49" (160 X 124 ,

2024



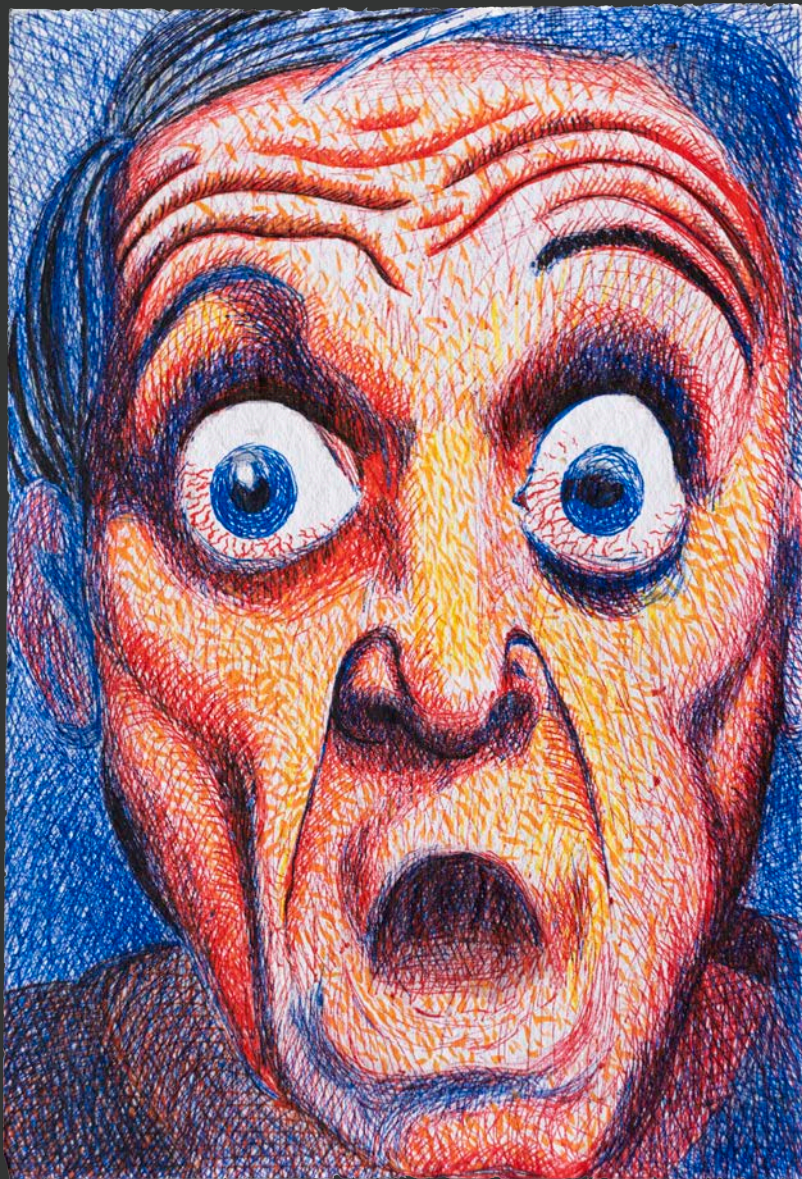
Somebody I know

Done on my iPad Pro and digital print on canvas

77" X 61" (201 X 156)

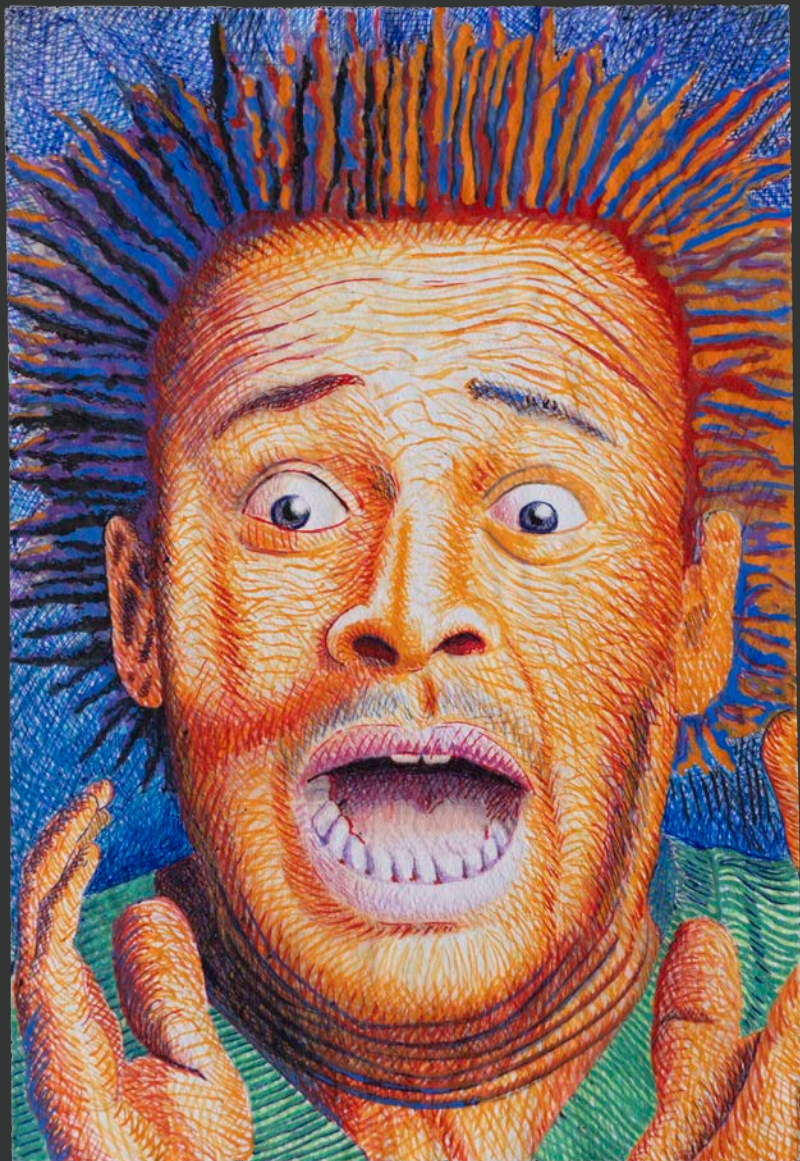
62" X 49" (160 X 124)

2024



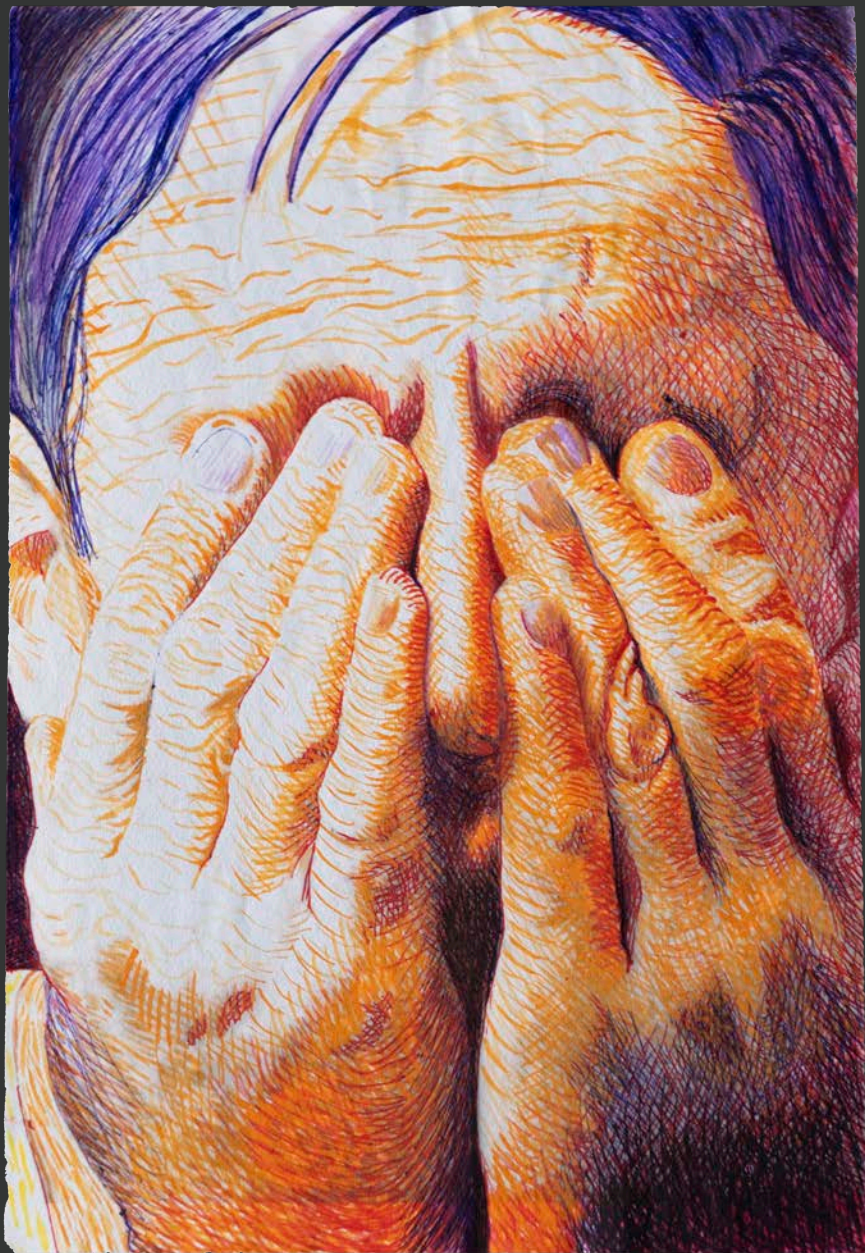
Shock

Mix media on handmade paper
11.75" X 8" (30 X 20 cms)
2024



Fear

Mix media on handmade paper
11.75" X 8" (30 X 20 cms)
2024



OMG

Mix media on handmade paper

11.75" X 8" (30 X 20 cms)

2024



Just looking

Mix media on handmade paper

10.75" X 7.5" (27 X 19 cms)

2024



Hands

Mix media on handmade paper
10.75" X 16" (27 X 40.5 cms)
2024



Sleep

Mix media on handmade paper

10.5" X 9 (26.5 X 23 cms)

2025



Sleepless

Mix media on handmade paper

10.5" X 9 (26.5 X 23 cms)

2025

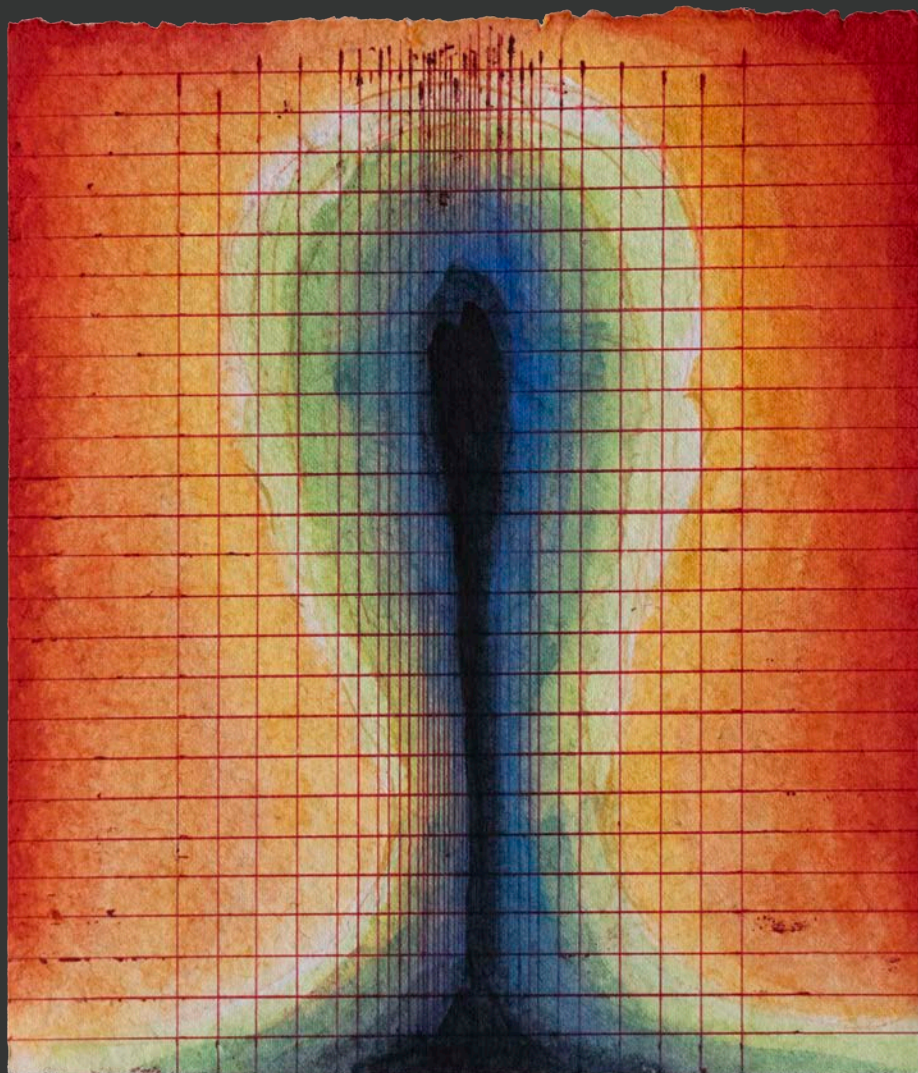


Restless

Mix media on handmade paper

10.5" X 9 (26.5 X 23 cms)

2025

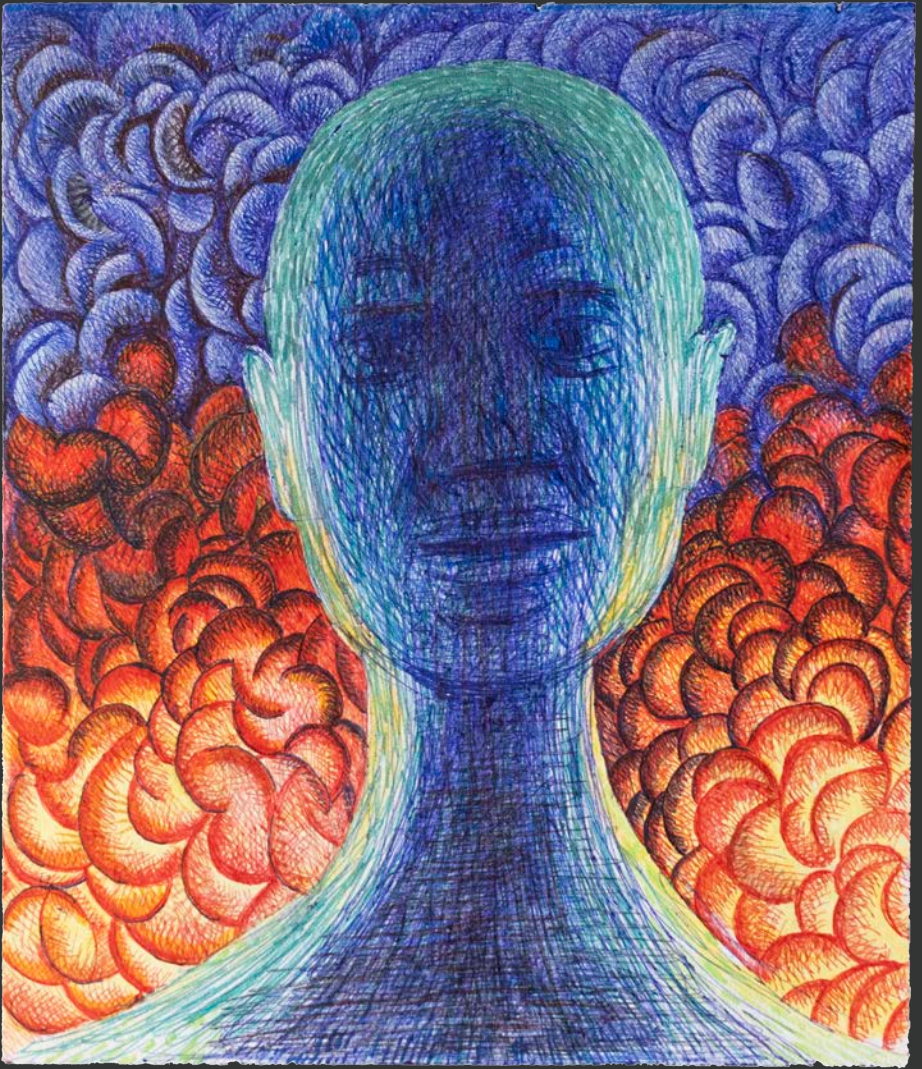


The Grid

Mix media on handmade paper

10.5" X 9 (26.5 X 23 cms)

2025



Against wasteland

Mix media on handmade paper

10.5" X 9 (26.5 X 23 cms)

2025



Wasteland

Mix media on handmade paper

10.5" X 9 (26.5 X 23 cms)

2025



Screaming horse (adapted from Picasso's Guernica)

Mix media on handmade paper

10.5" X 9 (26.5 X 23 cms)

2025



Screaming woman (adapted from Picasso's Guernica)

Mix media on handmade paper

10.5" X 9 (26.5 X 23 cms)

2025

PROFILE



Yunus Khimani completed his graduation and Post-graduation in Painting from Faculty of Fine Arts, M. S. University of Baroda in 1981. He has 30+ years teaching experience in various art and design institutes in India. He has been a practicing artist for over 50 year.

He has also been a designer involved in product development for 8 years (1988-1996) running own business. He spent a year in Mexico (1999-2000) on Mexican Government Scholarship. Was an Artist-in-Residence in La Esmeralda, School of Painting, Sculpture and Printmaking which was part Centro de les Artes, Mexico City.

He has had the fortune of exhibiting his art in India and abroad. Yunus was the Dean of Under Graduate program at Indian Institute of Crafts & Design in Jaipur where he got the opportunity of putting together a curriculum of a new under graduate program in Craft Design and its execution. It is here that he got first hand exposure of craft traditions of India.

As an artist interested in hand skills, he values his interaction with the craftsmen immensely.

He was Director of Maharaja Sawai Man Singh II Museum, City Palace, Jaipur for 9 years (2010- 2018). Since January, 2019, he is an independent artist.

Thanking

Jehangir Art Gallery (Mumbai), for considering my application and granting me this exhibition

Dr. Badshah Miyaan (Jaipur), Shilp Guru and master craftsman of Bandhej and Leheria, for teaching me textiles, natural dyes, ways of dyeing and initiating me into the art of hand painting with natural dyes on fabric.

Giriraj Chippa (Bagru) a traditional block printer, for being an associate in my foray into textiles. He generously opened his workshop for me and helped me in working with traditional textile processes.

Prof. (Dr.) Rajeev Lochan (Noida) for painstakingly writing the catalogue and for being a wonderful friend and supporter of my eccentric experimentations.

Yuriko Lochan (Noida) for being a great friend offering warmth and critique to my work.

Thakur Dushyant Singh Naila (Jaipur) for his great support always and opening up Naila Baug Palace, his home, for the preview in Jaipur.

Trivikram Singh Naila (Jaipur) for extending all support.

Rahul Sharma (Dubai) for designing invite, catalogue, poster and banner for the exhibition. Moreover, for being a loving friend who always stood by me initiating and keeping me updated with the digital media.

Akshita Gangwal (Jaipur) for friendship and sharing her knowledge and enthusiasm for textiles and natural dyes. She assisted throughout the planning of this exhibition.

Nishant Ghiya (Jaipur) for helping me with photography and putting together the exhibition.

Anjali Khandelwal (Jaipur) for help and design support and arrangements.

Rajesh Desai (Mumbai) for always being there.

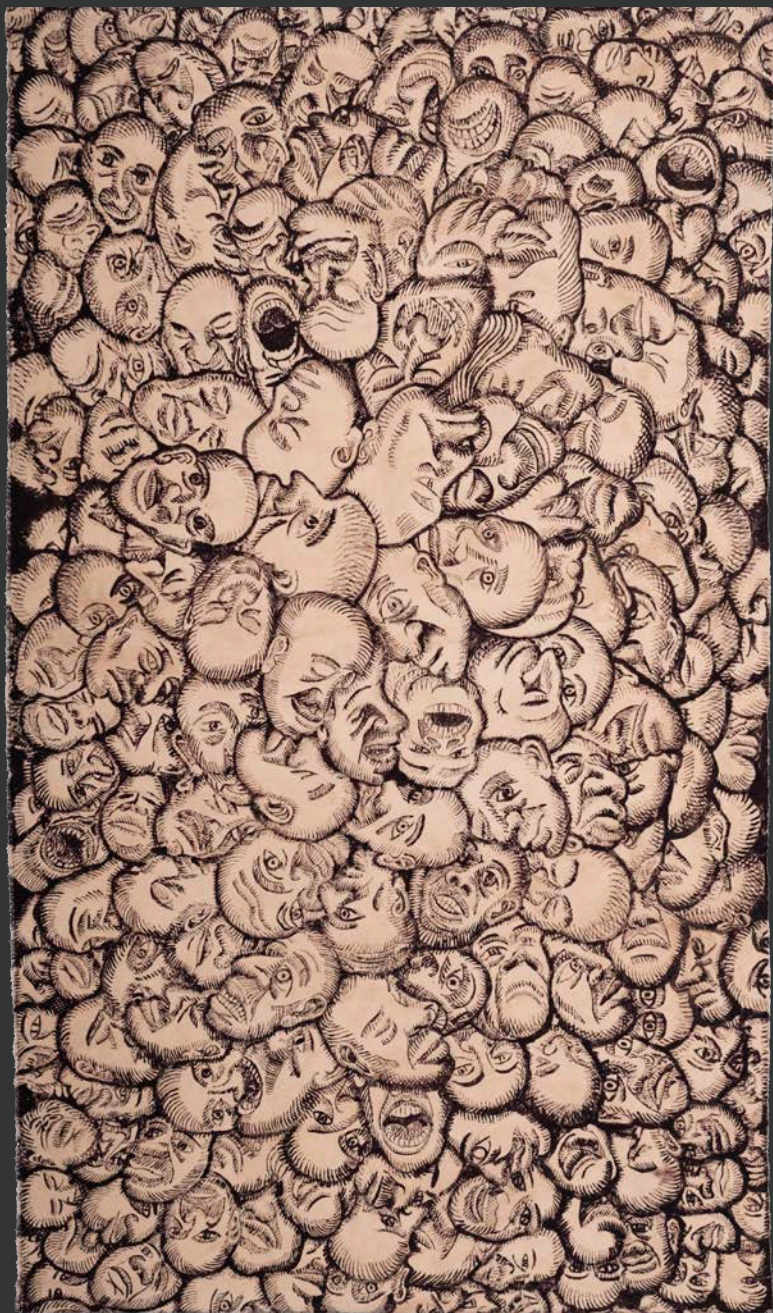
To my many **students** (difficult to list them here) who rubbed their youth on me offering unconditional love and support.



Pierced me

Mix media on handmade paper
10.5" X 9" (26.5 X 23 cms)
2025

This catalogue has been published on the occasion of an exhibition of paintings at Jehangir Art Gallery, Kala Ghoda, Mumbai from 30th December, 2025 to 5th January, 2026.



Head pile

Hand painted with natural dyes on canvas

85" X 49" (215 X 124 cms)

2025